

L E S S O N 13

# Who Is the Holy Spirit? (Most Misunderstood Person of the Trinity)

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## 5: The Holy Spirit

**Scripture Focus:** John 14:16-17 · Acts 5:3-4 · Ephesians 4:30 · Psalm 139:7-10

The Holy Spirit is the most misunderstood Person of the Trinity — sometimes over-mystified as a force to be manipulated, sometimes diminished to an impersonal influence. Scripture is clear: He is a Person with mind, emotions, and will, and He is fully God, co-equal and co-eternal with the Father and the Son.

B Y T H E E N D

## You Will...

|   |                                                                                               |
|---|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A | Explain the central discipleship issue in your own words.                                     |
| B | Connect the main truth to John 14:16-17 and Acts 5:3-4 and Ephesians 4:30 and Psalm 139:7-10. |
| C | Name one way this truth should shape your thinking, obedience, prayer, or witness.            |

V O C A B U L A R Y

### Key Terms

| THEME              | STUDY NOTE                                                                                                    |
|--------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Holy Spirit</b> | The divine Person who indwells, teaches, convicts, empowers, and forms believers into the likeness of Christ. |

| THEME            | STUDY NOTE                                                                                                         |
|------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Trinity</b>   | The one true God eternally existing as Father, Son, and Holy Spirit: one in essence, three in persons.             |
| <b>Scripture</b> | God's written Word, authoritative and sufficient for knowing Him, understanding salvation, and walking faithfully. |
| <b>Faith</b>     | Trusting God's Word and relying on Christ rather than self, merit, feeling, or religious performance.              |
| <b>Spirit</b>    | The Holy Spirit is the third person of the Trinity, fully God and co-equal with the father and the son.            |

## TEACHING NOTES

### I. The Main Question

Christian discipleship begins with learning to see the person of the Holy Spirit from Scripture rather than from instinct, habit, or surrounding culture. The goal is not simply to collect religious information, but to have the mind, conscience, and affections trained by God's Word. The Holy Spirit is the most misunderstood Person of the Trinity — sometimes over-mystified as a force to be manipulated, sometimes diminished to an impersonal influence. Scripture is clear: He is a Person with mind, emotions, and will, and He is fully God, co-equal and co-eternal with the Father and the Son.

A growing Christian asks: what does God require me to believe, reject, receive, or practice? Real maturity includes a clearer love for Christ, a humbler view of self, and a more faithful step of obedience.

### II. What Scripture Says

John 14:16-17 and Acts 5:3-4 and Ephesians 4:30 and Psalm 139:7-10 provide the biblical anchor. These passages keep the discussion tied to God's Word and give the learner a stable foundation for reflection. In John 14, as we saw in verse 16 and 7, Jesus promised to send, notice this, another helper, indicating the spirit would continue Christ's work.

Before moving too quickly to application, read the references slowly. Ask what the passage reveals about God, what it says about the human condition, what it commands or promises, and how it points the believer back to Christ. Scripture sets the agenda; Christian reflection follows where God has spoken.

### **III. The Doctrine Explained**

Doctrine matters because discipleship is built on truth. His ministry is vital in the life of the believer and in the life of the church. Doctrine is not a detached category for specialists; it names what every Christian is learning to believe, confess, defend, and practice.

Write the doctrine in your own words. Then ask how it fits into the larger story of Scripture: creation, fall, redemption, and Christian growth. A doctrine has been understood more deeply when it begins to reshape worship, repentance, assurance, humility, courage, and love.

## **SCRIPTURE SPOTLIGHT**

### **John 14:16-17**

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John 14:16-17 should be read as more than a proof text. It gives the subject its center of gravity and keeps Christian thinking inside God's revealed Word rather than personal opinion.

Read John 14:16-17 first, then read Acts 5:3-4 and Ephesians 4:30 and Psalm 139:7-10. Notice how the passages work together: one may name the doctrine, another may show its consequence, and another may press the believer toward obedience.

In John 14, as we saw in verse 16 and 7, Jesus promised to send, notice this, another helper, indicating the spirit would continue Christ's work.

#### **Study the passage:**

- 1. What does this passage teach about God, Christ, humanity, sin, grace, or obedience?*
- 2. What word or phrase should control how you understand this truth?*

3. How would this passage help a newer believer think more clearly?

FRAMEWORK

The Spirit's Work in the Believer

| THE SPIRIT DOES                         | THE BELIEVER RESPONDS                         |
|-----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| Indwells and seals God's people.        | Lives with assurance and reverence.           |
| Convicts and teaches through the Word.  | Listens, repents, and obeys.                  |
| Produces fruit and strengthens witness. | Walks dependently rather than self-reliantly. |

PAUSE & REFLECT

*Before moving on, write one sentence answering this: where does the person of the Holy Spirit most need to become clearer or more obedient in your own life?*

IV. Common Confusion

Common confusion usually begins when a biblical truth is reduced to a slogan, separated from its context, or filtered through personal experience. He's not a vague force or influence, but rather a divine person who shares equally in the nature and work of the father and the son. New believers especially need help seeing the difference between a biblical category and a half-true assumption.

When confusion appears, do not answer it only with opinion. Return to the text, define your terms, and make careful distinctions. Stability grows as hard questions are brought patiently under Scripture.

V. Why This Matters for Discipleship

Truth becomes fruitful when it forms the disciple. He's not a vague force or influence, but rather a divine person who shares equally in the nature and work of the father and the son. Biblical teaching should train the believer to worship, repent, trust, forgive, serve, pray, resist sin, and speak the gospel with clarity.

Ask where this truth should create maturity. Does it deepen assurance? Correct pride? Encourage obedience? Make Scripture more central? Strengthen witness? The question is not merely whether the content is understood, but what kind of disciple the truth is forming.

## VI. How This Changes Daily Life

The person of the Holy Spirit belongs in ordinary Christian life, not merely in a notebook. His ministry is vital in the life of the believer and in the life of the church. Identify one real setting where the truth should matter: a conversation, a temptation, a fear, a decision, a family moment, a church responsibility, or a private habit.

Growing in grace often happens through small, repeated acts of faithfulness. Choose one practice for this week that is concrete enough to obey, simple enough to remember, and biblical enough to strengthen your walk with Christ.

### KEY TAKEAWAYS

- **the person of the Holy Spirit should train the way a believer thinks, worships, and obeys.**
- **Scripture must set the terms before personal experience, church culture, or instinct is allowed to define the issue.**
- **A biblically faithful view will exalt the Holy Spirit in accordance with scripture, acknowledging his divine personhood and continuing work in the lives of us as believers.**
- **Christian maturity grows as doctrine moves from information into prayer, repentance, assurance, service, witness, and daily faithfulness.**

### REFLECTION

## Questions for the Lesson

1. *What should become clearer in your thinking about the person of the holy spirit?*
2. *Where does this truth correct a common misunderstanding or shallow habit?*

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**3.** *What is one concrete step of obedience, prayer, study, or conversation you should take this week?*

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PUT INTO PRACTICE

## A Discipleship Conversation

*Imagine a newer believer asks you about the person of the holy spirit. They are not asking for a lecture; they need a patient, Scripture-shaped answer that helps them trust Christ and take one faithful next step.*

**Your Task**

- 1.** Use John 14:16-17 to write a simple, biblical answer in your own words.

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- 2.** Name one practical step you would encourage this person to take this week.

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- 3.** Write one prayer request that fits the truth and the situation.

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